



Photo: NRC/ Albert Gonzalez Farran

Gatluak, from Mabil village in Unity State of South Sudan carries boxes of corn soya blend for her grandchildren during a food distribution.

SOUTH SUDAN | Hunger and hopelessness as conflict persists

Conflict continued unabated in 2016, spiking in the capital Juba in July. One in every five people in South Sudan have been forced to flee their homes, including over 1.6 million internally displaced people, and some 1 million refugees in neighbouring countries. A quarter of a million people have sought refuge in UN protection sites inside the country. Thousands of homes have been destroyed during the fighting and many people have been displaced multiple times because of repeated attacks.

Activities in information, counselling and legal advice helped to promote peace between communities in Alek, Aweil, Juba, Mingkaman and Wau. NRC focused on access to civil documentation and housing, land and property issues alongside collaborative dispute resolution activities.

NRC took leadership roles in inter-agency coordination. We were cluster sub-coordinators for both the protection cluster and the water, sanitation and hygiene cluster. Additional support to the humanitarian community was provided through an NRC Conflict and Policy Analyst.

Food security and livelihoods

NRC focused on food distribution and activities targeting communities' resilience capacity. Food security projects were implemented in both conflict-affected and more stable states. NRC ran food security projects with more long-term focus in Warrap, Western

and Northern Bahr El Ghazal. This included support in livelihood diversification, market linkages, capacity building and developing social infrastructure. NRC worked with World Food Programme to distribute food to people in extreme need through three rapid response teams, while piloting some mixed basket programmes in more stable areas.

In 2016, NRC supported over 566,000 people (321,000 female) with food support and improved resilience by supporting livelihood activities.

Water, sanitation and hygiene

NRC was an active member of the water, sanitation and hygiene cluster. We contributed to emergency programming at the national level, and participated in the Emergency Preparedness and Response Task Force. This led to NRC being a partner of choice for the cluster. The NRC water, sanitation and hygiene emergency response team regularly shared assessments and programme updates with the cluster at national level.

In 2016, NRC's emergency response team supported some 46,000 people (17,500 female) through water and sanitation activities. NRC repaired and rehabilitated boreholes and water points, promoted best hygiene practices, delivered hygiene messages, improved sanitation facilities in schools and constructed school latrines.

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Education

In 2016, NRC supported education of over 74,000 children and youth (31,000 female) among displaced and host communities in Northern and Western Bahr el Ghazal, Warrap, Unity, Jonglei, Lakes and Juba.

Most education interventions fell into three categories; education in emergency, the accelerated learning programme and the Youth Education Pack (YEP). Some pilot initiatives we ran included youth 'peace

clubs', protecting youth from sexual exploitation and abuse in schools, teacher crisis training, ICLA civil documentation for youth learners and YEP agricultural plots with food security training.

Information, counselling and legal assistance (ICLA)

Information, counselling and legal assistance activities focused on providing people access to civil documentation, and supporting housing, land and property issues. We also used NRC's global Collaborative Dispute Resolution model to promote peaceful co-existence between communities.

The project ran in Central Equatoria, Warrap, Lakes, Northern Bahr El Ghazal and Bor. It supported some 38,000 people (21,000 female) in 2016. It aimed to improve peaceful co-existence among communities through promoting messages on resolution of disputes by non-violent means. We also trained people on communication, mediation and negotiation through our Collaborative Dispute Resolution module.



Photo: NRC/ David Belluz

Women's groups in Warrap State of South Sudan were trained to grow vegetables during the dry season using new micro-irrigation systems in a unique private-public partnership between NRC, Global Affairs Canada and Agriteam.

“I RAN FROM SCHOOL TO SAVE MY LIFE”



Photo: NRC/Ingrid Prestetun

Daniel Boy fled from South Sudan with his little sister Eve Dawa. She is six years old. She was born deaf and mute. Daniel and Eve lost both their parents in the war.

“I saw the men coming out of the bush. They shot, plundered and butchered people,” said Daniel Boy (11). The war in South Sudan flared up again in the summer of 2016. Daniel was in school when it came to his hometown. “I ran from school, together with my friends. We ran, but the men followed. They shot those who ran, one by one.”

Daniel is from the city of Yei, in the south of the country. There has been war in South Sudan since 2013, but the fighting spread again last July. Daniel fled, alongside his sister Eve Dawa (6), his aunt and his cousin.

Daniels’ mother died in 2014, just after the war in South Sudan broke out for the first time. Daniel and his sister were living with their father, a carpenter.

“We had a good life,” said Daniel.

When the fighting started again this summer, armed groups arrested his father. “They took him with them and killed him,” he said. He realised his father had been killed only after he came to Uganda.

“I heard it from other people who knew him. My aunt was in the village when she heard my father had been arrested, and she decided to find us and take care of us.”

Daniel arrived in a reception centre for refugees in Kuluba, on the border between Uganda and South Sudan. “We spent three days traveling here from Yei. We had to take a detour through DR Congo because armed men had blocked the main road to Uganda,” he says.

While traveling to Uganda, they saw many dead bodies.

“I do not like war,” Daniel said with finality.